

Writing with Subject–Verb Agreement

WHAT DO YOU KNOW?

DISCUSS Look at the photo and read the caption. Discuss the questions.

1. Why is this a special event for the people in the photo?
2. What other special natural events do people enjoy watching?

FIND THE ERRORS This paragraph contains two errors with subject–verb agreement. Find the errors and correct them. Explain your corrections to a partner.

DESCRIPTIVE PARAGRAPH

The Amazing Jindo-Modo Land Bridge

¹Twice a year, something very interesting happens with the water of the Myeongryang Strait in South Korea. ²Between the months of April and June, extremely low ocean tides occur between the islands of Jindo and Modo. ³When this happens, a land bridge that is 1.3 miles long appear between the two islands, and this allows the residents to walk from one island to the other. ⁴During this time, people dig for clams in the mud of the temporary path and visit with friends. ⁵However, this land remains dry for only one hour, so their time together is very short. ⁶High tide soon covers the path, and all the people in the area looks forward to the next time that they can walk on the bottom of the sea.

Common Error 8.2 Does the verb agree with the subject?

is

The purpose of the lessons ~~are~~ to teach the police dog to open the door.

seem

Animals that perform in a theme park sometimes ~~seems~~ depressed.

- REMEMBER:**
- A noun after a preposition cannot be the subject. Look for the noun before the preposition.
 - A subject can be followed by an adjective clause. This clause gives more information about the subject. An adjective clause often starts with *who*, *that*, or *which*. The noun before the clause is the subject.

ACTIVITY 4 Common Error 8.2

Underline the subject. Then fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb or modal in parentheses. Use *not* when it is there.

1. According to a recent report, one of the most popular college majors _____ (*be*) nursing.
2. For health reasons, a patient with a history of diabetes _____ (*should, meet*) regularly with a doctor.
3. During the winter months in Japan, groups of snow monkeys _____ (*spend*) a great deal of time in hot springs.
4. Each year the overall winner of the Tour de France cycling race _____ (*receive*) about \$576,000.
5. Until 1950, the two tallest buildings in the world _____ (*be*) the Empire State Building in New York and the Eiffel Tower in Paris.
6. Plants that grow in the desert _____ (*not, need*) very much water to live.
7. The record for most tennis games in a tiebreaker at Wimbledon _____ (*be*) still 70-68. John Isner and Nicolas Mahut set this record in 2010.
8. A job candidate who has strong technology skills _____ (*have*) an advantage over others.



Fruit bats fly in the early evening at Kasanka National Park, Zambia. These bats are part of a colony of about 8 million bats.

ACTIVITY 7 Building Greater Sentences

Combine these short sentences into one sentence. You can add new words and move words around, but you should not add or omit any ideas. More than one answer is possible, but all of these sentences require forms for subject–verb agreement.

1.
 - a. Bats consume insects.
 - b. Bats eat almost 3,000 insects.
 - c. Bats do this in one night.

2.
 - a. There are five volcanoes.
 - b. These volcanoes are in the world.
 - c. Only these contain lava lakes.

3.
 - a. Gymnastics is a sport.
 - b. Soccer is a sport.
 - c. Both are popular sports.
 - d. Both are Olympic sports.

ACTIVITY 8 Steps to Composing

Read the paragraph. Then follow the directions in the 10 steps to edit the information and composition of this paragraph. Write your revised paragraph on a separate sheet of paper. Be careful with capitalization and punctuation. Check your answers with the class.

DESCRIPTIVE PARAGRAPH

Animal Communication

¹ Animals do not use words. ² Animals can communicate. ³ One way that animals are able to communicate is by making sounds. ⁴ For example, cats purr when they are happy, but they hiss to show anger. ⁵ Many types of insects rub their wings or legs together to send information. ⁶ Other animals use body language to communicate. ⁷ A dog uses its tail to transmit many messages. ⁸ A tail wag can mean that the animal is happy or scared. ⁹ Some animals communicate using odors. ¹⁰ Bears will rub against a tree to mark their personal areas. ¹¹ Bees release a body chemical to warn other bees about danger. ¹² Although animals do not have the ability to use words, they can most certainly express themselves.

1. Combine sentences 1 and 2 with the word *but*. Use a pronoun to avoid repeating the noun *animals*. Add correct punctuation.
2. In sentence 3, change *animals* to *animal* and make other necessary changes.
3. In sentence 4, change *cats* to *cat* and make other necessary changes.
4. In sentence 6, add the word *also* before the verb to mark the second major supporting sentence.
5. In sentence 7, change *dog* to *dogs* and make other necessary changes.
6. In sentence 8, add the adjective *angry* near the end of the sentence.
7. In sentence 9, add *Finally*, to the beginning of the sentence to mark the last major supporting sentence. Be sure to include the comma after this connecting word.